Northwestern Medicine | Robert H. Lurie Comprehensive Cancer Center of Northwestern University

20th Annual Pain & Palliative Care Conference

Tuesday, June 16, 2026 • Feinberg Pavilion, Northwestern Memorial Hospital • Chicago, Illinois

8:00 a.m. **Registration & Breakfast**

8:50 a.m. **Welcome & Opening Remarks**
Edward Peñate, DMin, BCC
Palliative Care Chaplain
Palliative Medicine/Spiritual Care & Education
Northwestern Medicine

9:00 a.m. KEYNOTE
Medical Aid in Dying in Illinois: A Practical Primer for Practicing Clinicians
Eytan Szmuilowicz, MD
Palliative Medicine, Northwestern Medicine

10:00 a.m. **Buprenorphine in Palliative Care**
Melanie Smith, MD
Assistant Professor of Medicine,
Section of Palliative Medicine, Northwestern University

10:30 a.m. **Break**

11:00 a.m. **Restorative Justice in Palliative Care**
Aretha Boakye-Donkor, MD
Palliative Care Fellow, Northwestern University

11:30 a.m. **Legacy Work in Palliative Care: Practical Tools for Meaningful Conversations**
Jaleesa Harris, MD
Palliative Care Fellow, Northwestern University

12:00 p.m. **Where Transplant Meets Palliative Care: A Practical Approach to Advanced Liver Disease**
Nivetha Saravanan, MD
Palliative Care Fellow, Northwestern University

12:30 p.m. **Lunch Break**

1:30 p.m. **Hoping for a Miracle and Medical Decision-Making**
MODERATOR
Edward Peñate, DMin, BCC
Palliative Care Chaplain
PANEL
Erin A. Strong, MD, MBA, MPH
Assistant Professor, Surgical Oncology
Loyola University Medical Center
Kia L. Ferrer, PhD, CCLS
Certified Child Life Specialist, Northwestern Medicine
Ornella Razetto, LCSW, ACM-SW
CDT Social Worker, Northwestern Medicine
Elijah Kindred
Community & Population Health Advisor
Bright Star Community Outreach
Rev. Pamela N. Floyd, MD, MPH, MDiv.
Staff Chaplain for Palliative Medicine,
Northwestern Medicine

3:00 p.m. SPECIAL LAST LECTURE
Pain in Serious Illness: What a Long, Strange Trip It's Been
Judith Paice, PhD, RN
Director, Cancer Pain Program, Northwestern Medicine
Lurie Cancer Center

3:30 p.m. **Closing Remarks & Completion of Evaluation Forms**
Eytan Szmuilowicz, MD
Palliative Medicine, Northwestern Medicine

This nursing continuing professional development activity was approved by VTL Center for Professional Development, an accredited approver by the American Nurses Credentialing Center's Commission on Accreditation.

This continuing professional development conference will award 5.0 contact hours for nurses. Additionally, this activity provides 5.0 continuing education contact hours for physical therapists and occupational therapists, and 4.0 continuing education hours for social workers. For more information regarding contact hours, please contact cancer@northwestern.edu